

Locked evidence is favorable—but deliberately two-sided

OBSERVED RESULTS

32 held-out synthetic instances · four-task retained sets · noiseless statevector · 128 matched draws



30/32

strict feasible core



25/32

cluster repair wins



9/32

post-simulation gate



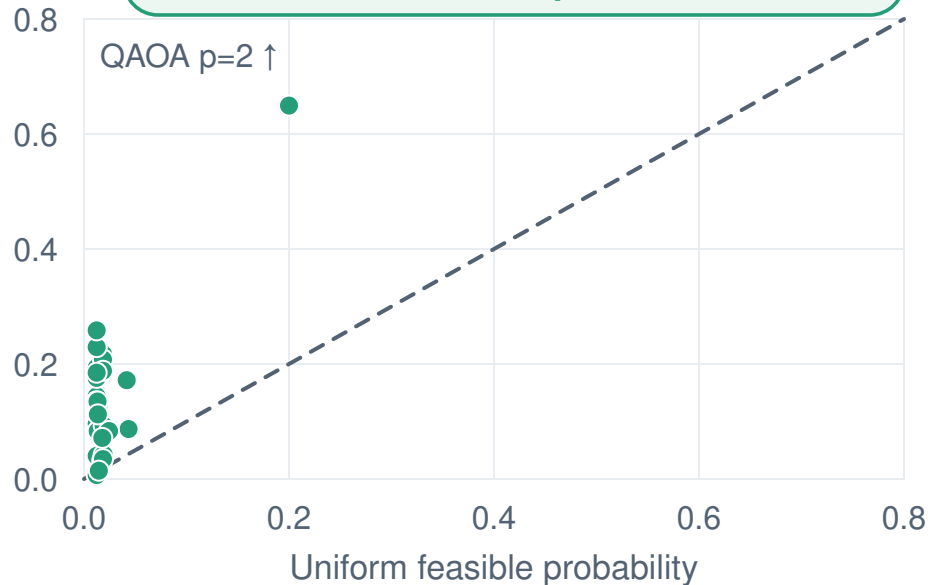
0/32

explicit mode violations

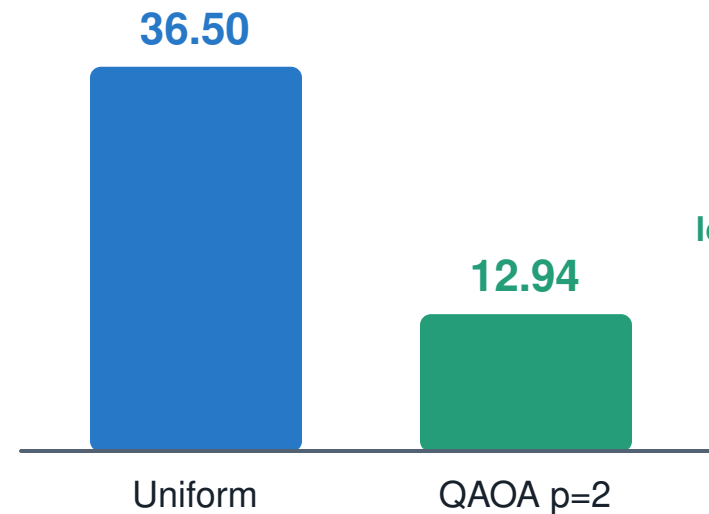


A Optimum probability (paired)

mean 0.022 → 0.152; $p=2 > U$ on 30/32



B Matched-budget first-hit proxy



mean reduction: 23.56 draws



Counterevidence retained

$p=1 > p=2$ on 28/32 (unequal searches); composite-feasible incumbents 27/32; the gate is computed after QAOA.